human figures portrayed on the seals have in common with many of the animals also shown are horns. As the distinguished archaeologist Jonathan M. Kenoyer has remarked in connection with the 'Shiva-as-Pashupati' seal, 'Large horns could represent the power, strength, and virility of the animal; by analogy whoever wore a headdress with the horns would possess similar attributes. The anthropomorphic figures with these headdresses may depict powerful hunters or shamans, or even some form of water buffalo or cattle deity.'[9]

Everything we know about the Harappan Civilisation shows that it was a farming culture that depended on the summer monsoon and the melting of the Himalayan snows combining annually to flood its fields with a rich layer of silt. Initially there was too much of both monsoon rain and snow-melt, leading to widespread inundation, but from about 3000 BCE onwards a steady easing-off of monsoon rainfall meant a decrease in flooding, which greatly encouraged farming and urban settlement. But as the monsoon continued to decline, providing less summer precipitation, so the flow of those rivers most dependent on this source was reduced. Consequently, this highly developed urban civilisation went into decline from about 2100 BCE onwards, characterised by a withdrawal from the big city centres and a shift towards the edges of the Harappan heartland, with a marked build-up of settlements in the region covered by today's Punjab and Haryana states, and a smaller concentration on the Kathiawar peninsula. What followed has been described as a 'collapse', with many factors besides reduced rainfall playing their part, including earthquakes and river capture.[10]

By about 1800 BCE the great urban centres of the Harappans had been all but abandoned as the lower Punjab experienced something similar to what occurred in Britain after the collapse of the Roman empire. The Romans left